

ALMILA BASAK

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Political Science
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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy — Political Science 2021 – 2027
Syracuse University *(Expected)*

- Fields: Comparative Politics (Major), Law and Courts (Minor)
- Dissertation: *Varieties of Right-Wing Populism in Europe*
- Committee: Seth K Jolly (Chair), Margarita Estevez-Abe, Jessie Trudeau

Master of Arts — Political Science 2021 – 2023
Syracuse University

Bachelor of Science - Political Science and Public Administration 2014 – 2019
Middle East Technical University, Turkey
Minor: Economics

ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS

Graduate Research Associate 2024 – Present
Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs,
Center for European Studies, Syracuse University

Graduate Research Associate 2023 – Present
Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs,
Middle Eastern Studies Program, Syracuse University

Teaching Associate 2023 – 2026
Future Professoriate Program,
Syracuse University

Research

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Subfields: Political Parties, Populism, Comparative Political Economy, Politics of Social Policy, European Politics, Turkish Politics

WORKING PAPERS

- [3] "Welfare Promises of Populist Right Parties: Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?"
- [2] "The Electoral Returns to Bending Campaign Rules: Evidence from Brazil" (with Dr. Trudeau)
- [1] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers? Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence" (with Dr. Jolly)

IN PROGRESS

- [3] "Social Policy Preferences in Populist Welfare Regimes: Evidence from Turkey"
- [2] "Understanding the Gender Gap in Party Preferences: The role of welfare state inclusiveness"

- [1] Measuring Issue Salience for Party Manifestos using LLMs: Alternative to Hand-coding?

RESEARCH	Graduate Research Assistant,	
APPOINTMENTS	<i>Dr. Jessie Trudeau</i>	Spring 2026
	Graduate Research Assistant,	
	<i>Dr. Jessie Trudeau</i>	Spring 2025
	Graduate Research Assistant,	
	<i>Dr. Jessie Trudeau</i>	2023-2024
	Global Free Speech Repository Research Assistant,	
	<i>Dr. Thomas Keck</i>	2022 – 2023
CONFERENCE	[13] "Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties:Whom to Attract	
PRESENTATIONS	and How to Allocate?"	June 2026
	presented at the APSA Dissertation Workshop on European Politics.	
	[12] "Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties:Whom to Attract	
	and How to Allocate?"	April 2026
	presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference.	
	[11] "The electoral returns to vote buying: Evidence from Brazil"	April 2026
	presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference	
	with Dr. Jessie Trudeau.	
	[10] "The electoral returns to vote buying: Evidence from Brazil"	April 2026
	presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	
	[9] "Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties:Whom to Attract	
	and How to Allocate?"	March 2026
	presented at the European Politics Workshop at Syracuse University.	
	[8] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers?	
	Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence"	May 2025
	presented at the European Union Studies Association Conference	
	with Prof Seth Jolly.	
	[7] "Welfare Platforms of Populist Entrepreneurs"	March 2025
	presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	
	[6] "Welfare Platforms of Populist Entrepreneurs"	March 2025
	presented at the European Politics Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	
	[5] "Welfare State Policies: Window for Party Politics?,"	September 2024
	presented at the American Political Science Association Conference.	
	[4] "Welfare State Policies: Window for Party Politics?,"	April 2024
	presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	
	[3] "Understanding the Gender Gap in Party Preferences:	
	The Case of the AKP era in Turkey"	March 2025
	presented at the European Politics Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	
	[2] "Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP,"	November 2022
	presented at the Northeastern Political Science Association.	
	[1] "Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP,"	September 2022
	presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	

SKILLS

Statistics Software: R, R Studio, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, GitHub, MAXQDA
Document Preparation Systems: L^AT_EX, R Markdown, Microsoft Office Suite

Teaching

TEACHING ASSISTANT	PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics, <i>Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe</i> Role: Section Leader	Fall 2025
	PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics, <i>Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe</i> Role: Section Leader	Fall 2024
INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD	PSC 388 Globalization and the Rise of Populism	May 2024

Grants, Awards, and Honors

GRANTS	APSA Travel Grant <i>American Political Science Association</i>	2026
	Summer Dissertation Fellowship <i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	2026
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	2026
	Research Assistantship Fellowship <i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	Spring 2026
	Roscoe Martin Fund for Dissertation and Thesis Research <i>Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs, Syracuse University</i>	2025
	Goekjian/Center for European Studies Research Grant <i>Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Syracuse University</i>	2025
	Research Assistantship Fellowship <i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	Spring 2025
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Graduate Student Organization, Syracuse University</i>	2024
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Graduate Student Organization, Syracuse University</i>	2023
	Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2022-23
	Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2021-22

AWARDS	The Ketcham Award <i>For students whose work exhibits a commitment to open and just public life</i> <i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	2026
	Certificate in University Teaching <i>The Future Professoriate Program, Syracuse University</i>	2026
	Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award <i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	2026
	Koff Award <i>The best graduate student paper written each year on comparative politics</i> <i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	2025
	Young Scholar Prize <i>For the paper "Social Policy and the Gender Gap in Party Preferences: The Case of the AKP era in Turkey"</i> <i>Middle East Studies Program, Syracuse University</i>	2023
HONORS	Graduated as first-ranked student of the Middle East Technical University's Political Science Department	June 2019
	Graduated as third-ranked student of the Middle East Technical University	June 2019

Service

TO THE INSTITUTION	Co-President , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2023-2024
	Pre-Comprehensive Exams Student Representative , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2022-2023
	Political Science Department Representative , Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization, Graduate Pandemic Committee member	2021-2022
TO THE DISCIPLINE	Panelist , <i>Independent Teaching as a Graduate Student</i> organized by Future Professoriate Program	October 2025
	Co-organizer , <i>Future Professoriate Program seminar:</i> <i>"How to present at a conference?"</i> at Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse University	October 2024
	Organizer , <i>Geocoding Workshop with Dr Trudeau</i> for Political Science Graduate Students.	October 2024
	Co-organizer , <i>Future Professoriate Program seminar:</i> <i>"Predocs, Postdocs, and Fellowships: What You Need to Know"</i> at Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse University.	December 2023
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	European Political Science Society	2026 – Present
	Midwest Political Science Association	2026 – Present
	European Union Studies Association	2025 – Present

American Political Science Association

2024 – Present

Updated June 3, 2026